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Denver delays Axon ALPR camera contract

By **Deborah Grigsby** March 23, 2026 | updated 1 month ago



Dozens of residents gave testimony during an hour-long courtesy public hearing on a proposed new contract for automated license plate reading cameras. The city's current contract with Georgia-based Flock Group expires March 31, 2026. (Deborah Grigsby, The Denver Gazette)



The City and County of Denver still hasn't officially broken up with automated license plate reading camera vendor Flock Group, as members of the City

Council agreed Monday to delay approving a new contract with Arizona-based ALPR maker Axon.



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Residents and privacy advocates filled the Parr-Widener Community Room for a special one-hour courtesy public hearing on the matter, with 55 individuals signed up for comment.

While Axon's proposed \$150,000 contract for a 50-camera system is about half of Denver's current 111-camera system with Flock, opponents argue the technology poses the same risks because there are "no proper guardrails" in place to protect their privacy and personally identifiable information, the statement added.

Privacy and civil rights advocates have stated that the matter has come down to the wire as Flock's contract with the city ends March 31.

The new Axon contract was not shared with Task Force members until March 19, and shared with the City Council on March 13, just five days before the committee vote, according to a statement from the American Civil Liberties Union.

Denver City Council members hear public testimony on Monday, March 23, 2026, regarding a proposed new contract between the City and Axon, a vendor of automated license plate reading (ALPR) cameras. (Debroah Grigsby, The Denver Gazette)

[In a letter sent to the Denver City Council](#) prior to the vote, several community, advocacy, and civil rights organizations, as well as the Denver Surveillance Task Force, asked the councilors to vote "no" to "prevent the city from rushing into a new contract."

The opponents argued that Mayor Mike Johnston's plan to switch vendors "does little to protect the civil rights of people living and visiting Denver."



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Supporters of the technology, which include Johnston and the Denver police, say it saves lives and helps solve crimes.

"What we have done with this contract is try to balance the very real benefit to public safety that it provides with the very legitimate privacy and civil liberty considerations that the mayor shares, and that you all members of council chair and that these community members have shared, Johnston spokesperson Tim Hoffman said.

Added: "Yes, get to take advantage of this tool, which has helped us reduce crime in Denver, and making sure that we have robust safe."

"Let's give DPD access to the technology that can help them quickly find, track and remove the threat of violent criminals from our streets," Denver Business owner Derek Friedman told City Council members.

"The city cannot simply move from one dragnet surveillance company to another and trust that these for-profit companies will put people's civil liberties first," ACLU of Colorado's public policy director, Anaya Robinson, said.



artist's rendering of a modern building with a security camera

Denver Mayor Mike Johnston has floated a 12-month \$150,000 contract with Arizona-based Axon for 50 new license plate reading cameras and the software to support them. The proposed contract will replace the city's existing agreement with Flock Safety, whose contract expires March 31, 2026. (Courtesy, Axon.com)

Robinson added: "The city must implement critical protections around data retention, information sharing, access limitations, and meaningful community input and legislative approval policies to prevent abuses from government

agencies and law enforcement. Continuing to operate this risky, unregulated surveillance technology in the city carries far greater risks than pausing the AI PR program ”



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found it to be especially strong carefully threading the needle between the ambitious goals of improving public safety while also protecting the collection, storage, sharing and use of surveillance technology,” Engel said.

But just because the city of Denver will no longer have an agreement with Flock, privately owned Flock cameras, owned by HOAs and local businesses, will still remain, and Denver police could still have access to them if the owning entity cooperates.

The resolution will be back before the full City Council body on March 31, as City Council offices will be closed on Monday, March 30.



a police officer holding a body-worn camera

The Denver Department of Public Safety has a new five-year, \$27 million contract with Arizona-based Axon for 2,563 new body cameras and 2,175 Tasers. (Courtesy, Axon)

Axon is no stranger to the Mile High City.

In December 2025, the City Council approved a new five-year, \$27 million contract with Axon for 2,563 new body cameras and 2,175 Tasers.



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